Ryder
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RYDER E-COMMERCE CONSUMER STUDY

How U.S. Consumers Are Shopping in 2025



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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Given recent economic uncertainty, retail brands across all categories and channels face additional challenges in trying to predict this year's consumer behavior and accurately forecast demand. Nevertheless, one of the best ways to plan for upcoming seasons is to reflect on the valuable consumer behavior insights gained from the previous ones. By blending historical data and trends with current economic indicators, brands can build more robust and realistic demand forecasts. As we examine the findings of our 11th annual e-commerce consumer benchmark survey, "How U.S. Consumers Are Shopping in 2025," one thing is clear – **consumers want the flexibility to shop when, where, and how they want, and they expect an exceptional customer experience throughout the entire fulfillment journey.**

The certainty of uncertainty

While recent events may feel unprecedented, at Ryder, we have seen our customers through many periods of ambiguity, strain, and turmoil. The COVID-19 pandemic disrupted forecasting models, making it immensely challenging to make accurate predictions. Leaning on our more than 90 years of experience in navigating all kinds of disruption across industries helped to guide our customers in the right direction then, just as we are doing now.

No matter the disruption, consumer expectations of reliability and convenience prevail, underscoring the importance of maintaining a consistent, responsive experience across all sales channels and an agile, resilient supply chain. This approach enables sellers to navigate disruptions successfully while capturing new customers' attention, optimizing sales opportunities, deepening customers' trust and loyalty, and earning their continued business.

Improving omnichannel integration with in-store pickup availability, flexible return policies, personalized marketing, and cross-channel loyalty programs can help create a more cohesive, enjoyable shopping journey customers will want to replicate. These optimizations can also create more cost savings for consumers, further improving their overall experience.



Steve Sensing
President,
Supply Chain & Dedicated Transportation Solutions,
Ryder System, Inc.

Preparing for the 2025 holiday shopping season

To get a complete picture of the shopper mindset, we must examine the holiday shopping season independently. The holiday season brings unique needs, preferences, behaviors, and circumstances that can differ greatly compared to the rest of the year. To supplement these distinctions, we supplemented this year's annual consumer study with a special report.

To contribute actionable data for 2025 holiday season planning, Ryder hired a third-party research company to survey their behaviors, preferences, experiences, and expectations during the 2024 holiday shopping season. The survey covered purchasing behavior, shipping, returns, omnichannel experience, sustainability, and supply chain factors.

Additionally, given the economic uncertainty in the first half of 2025, we followed up our initial research with a pulse survey in May 2025 to gauge consumer outlook for the upcoming holiday season.

With this combined survey data, our 2025 e-commerce consumer study is our most comprehensive yet, helping brands understand and adapt to the evolving retail landscape and latest consumer expectations. This study provides brands and retailers with consumer insights to help guide their omnichannel sales and supply chain strategies, ultimately enhancing the customer experience.



E-COMMERCE TRENDS



E-COMMERCE TRENDS: KEY TAKEAWAYS

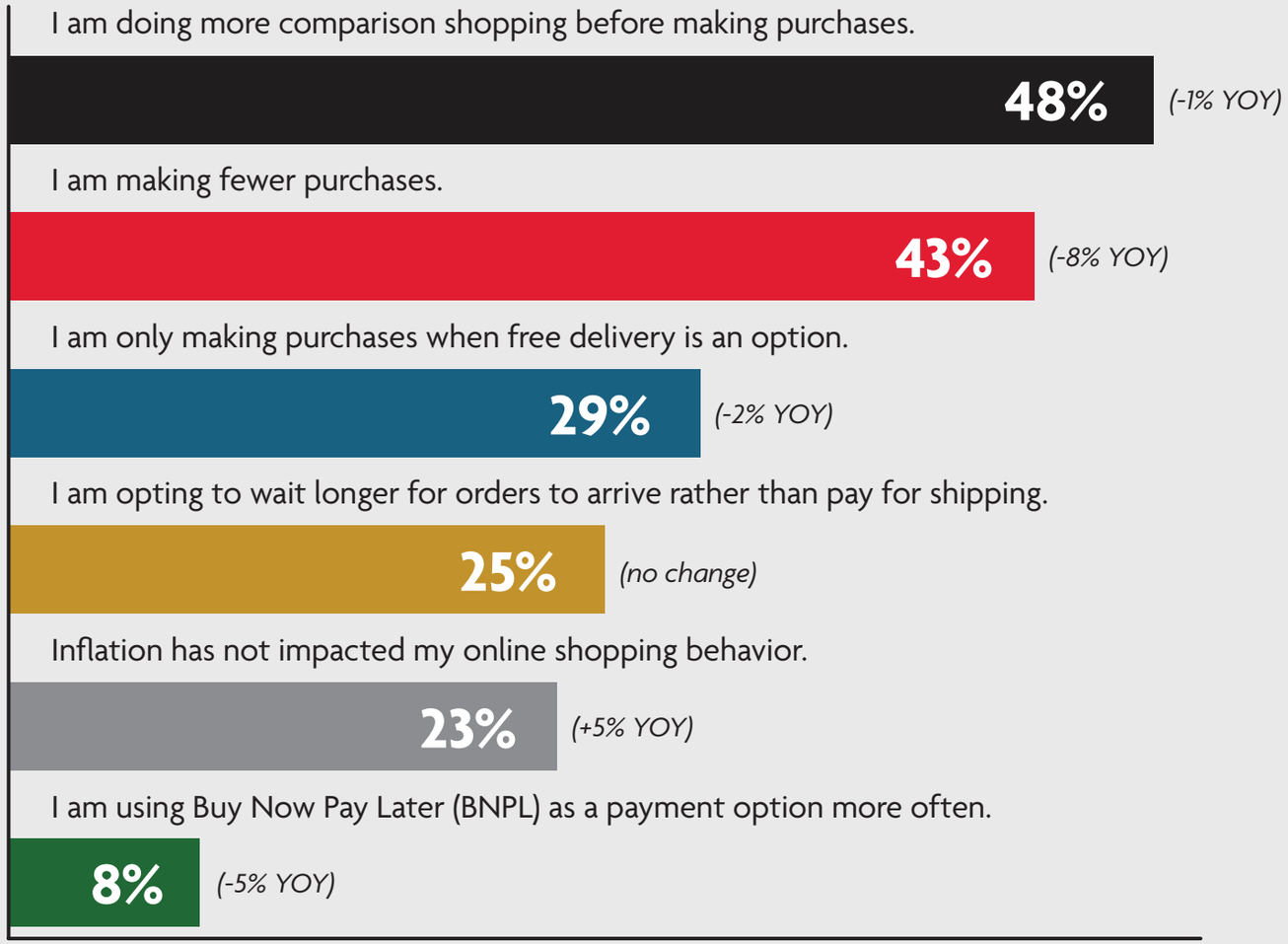
- Fewer consumers are attributing shifts in non-essential shopping behavior to inflation.
- Younger shoppers' non-essential purchase habits are more affected by inflation.
- Inflation cuts deepest into spending on clothing, home goods, electronics, and accessories.
- U.S. shoppers value American-made products.
- Older shoppers are more likely to buy American-made, but not at a higher cost.



Fewer consumers are attributing shifts in non-essential shopping behavior to inflation.



"How is inflation impacting your non-essential online shopping behavior?"

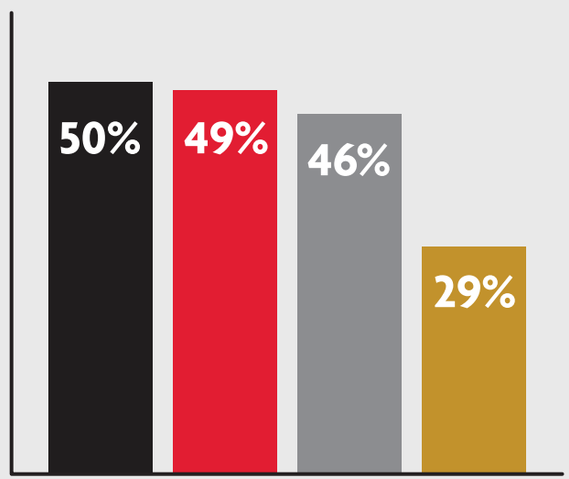


Note: Percentages may not total 100% due to rounding and/or because respondents could select more than one answer.

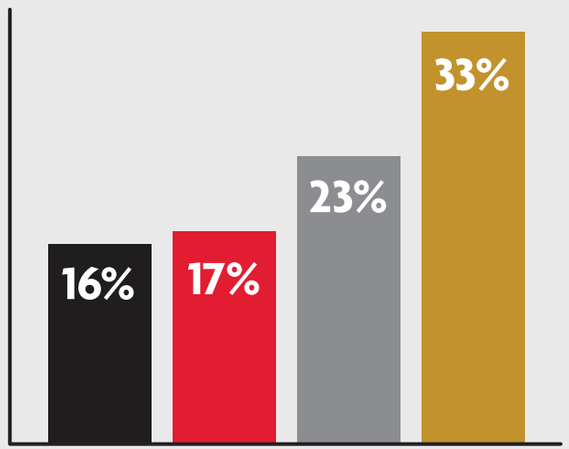
Younger shoppers' non-essential purchase habits are more affected by inflation.

How inflation is impacting non-essential online shopping behavior:

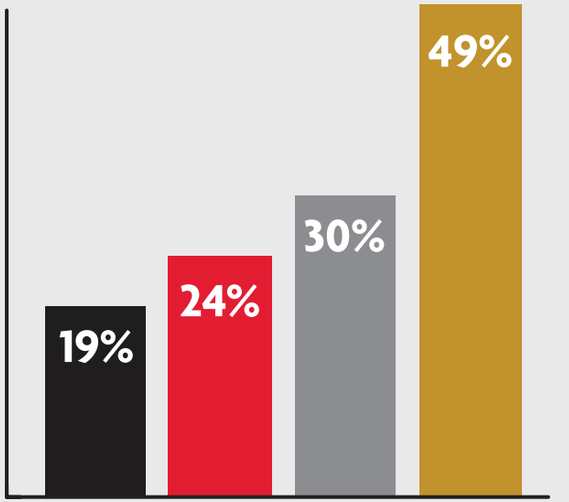
"I am making fewer purchases."



"Inflation has not impacted my online shopping behavior."



"I have not scaled back on purchasing anything due to inflation."



AGE GROUPS:

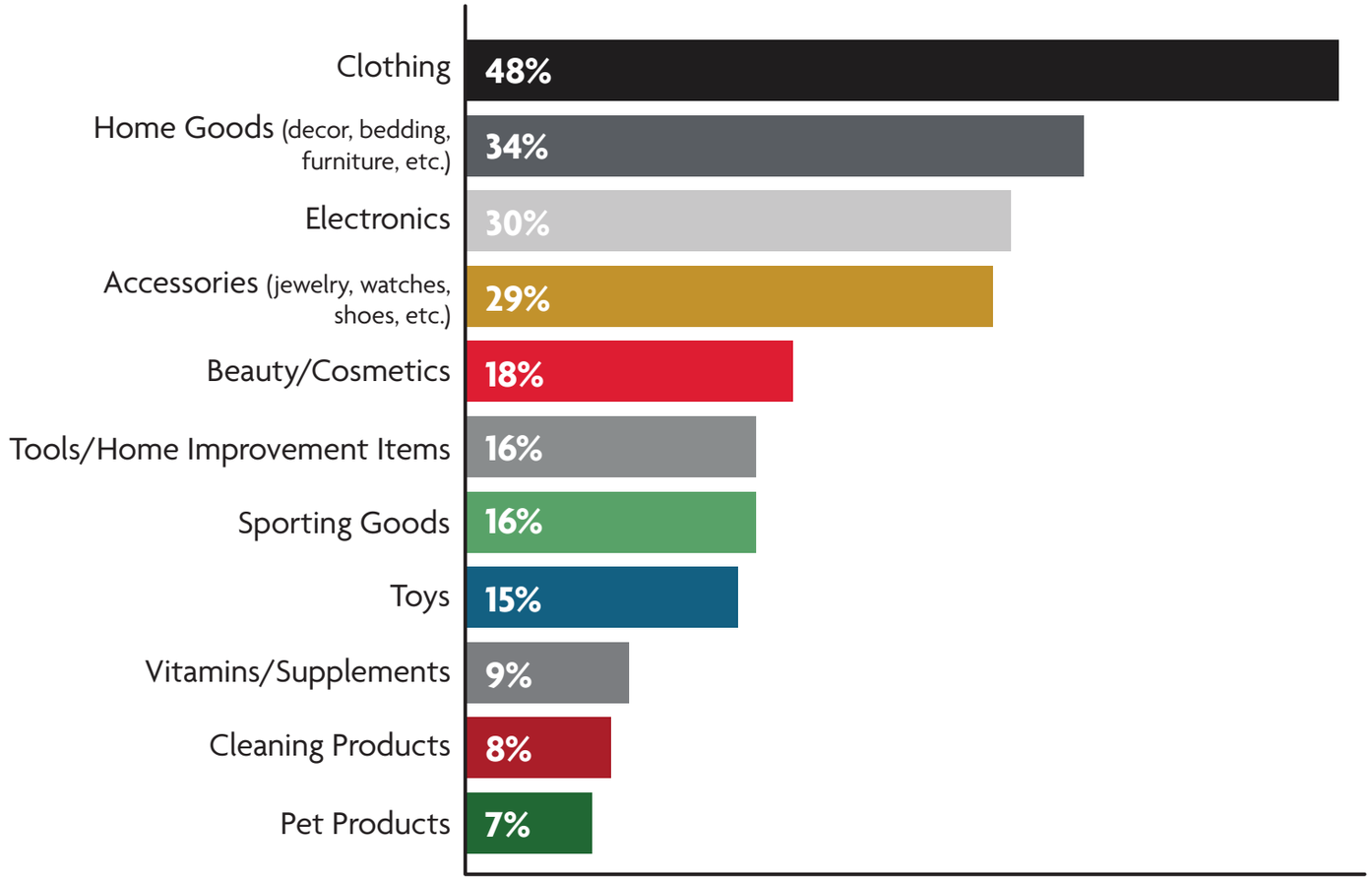
18-29 30-44 45-60 >60

Note: Percentages may not total 100% due to rounding and/or because respondents could select more than one answer.

Inflation cuts deepest into spending on clothing, home goods, electronics, and accessories.

"Which of the following items have you scaled back on purchasing in the past year specifically due to inflation?"

Note: Percentages may not total 100% due to rounding and/or because respondents could select more than one answer.



U.S. shoppers value American-made products.

74% of shoppers would be **more likely** to purchase a product that is **made in the U.S.**

Of these shoppers, **nearly half (48%) would be willing to pay a higher price** for an American-made product.

"Which of the following items would you be more likely to purchase if they were made in the U.S.?"

Top 5 Product Categories

65%	Clothing
57%	Vitamins/Supplements
47%	Home Goods
47%	Electronics
45%	Cleaning Products

18%

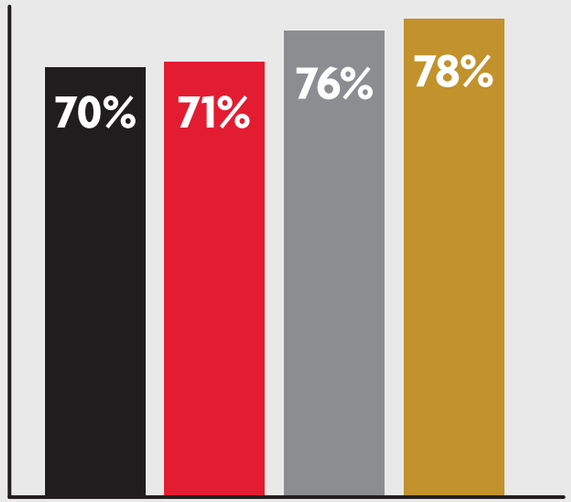
of shoppers find out where a product is manufactured before purchasing it.



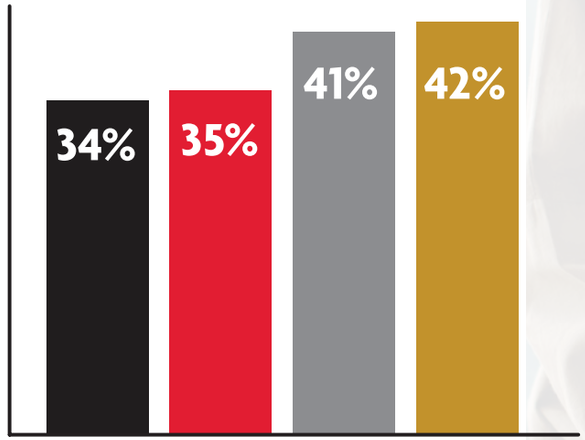
Note: Percentages may not total 100% due to rounding and/or because respondents could select more than one answer.

Older shoppers are more likely to buy American-made, but not at a higher cost.

Shoppers who would be more likely to buy products made in the U.S.



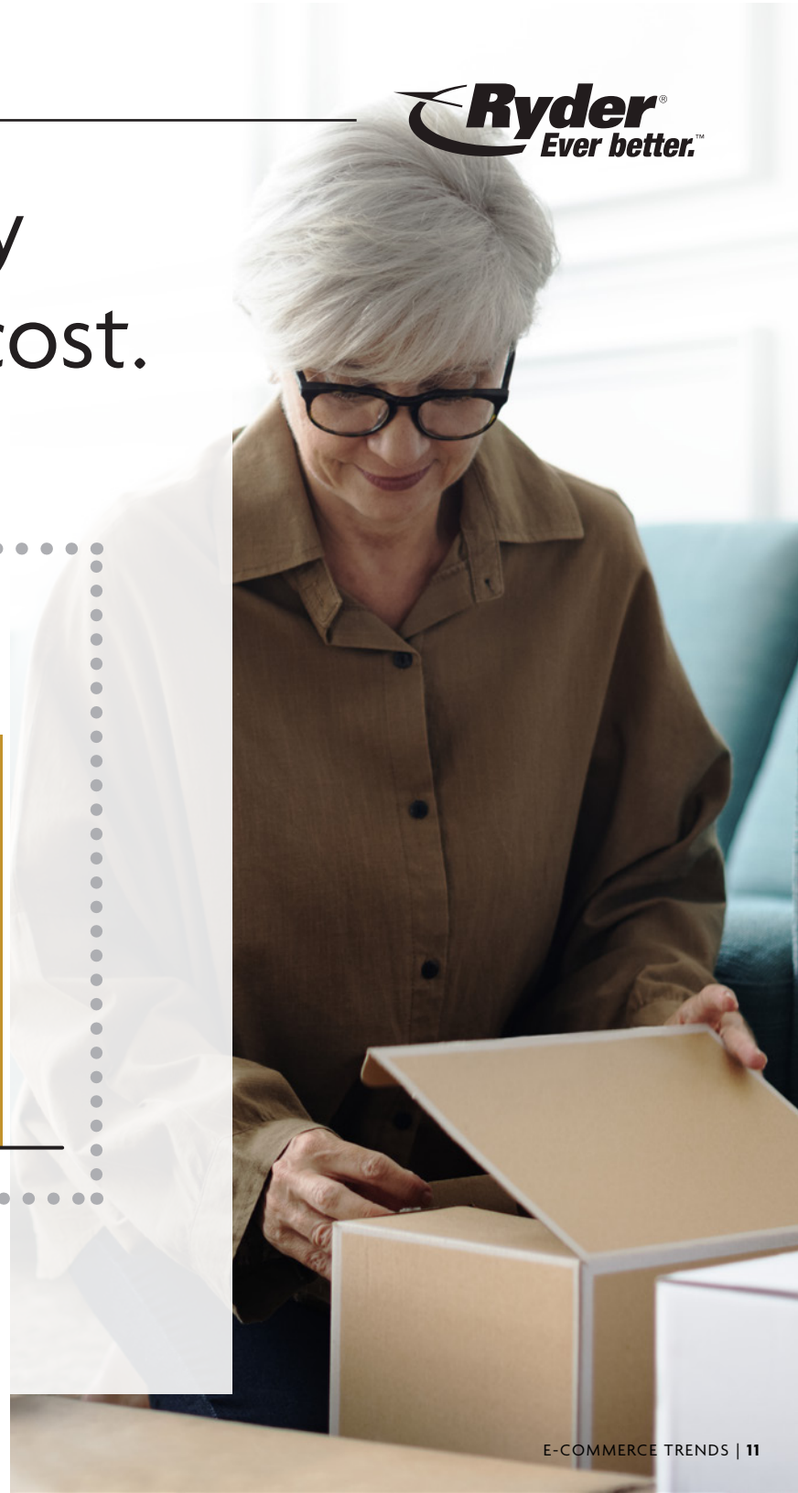
"...but not if I have to pay more for American-made."



AGE GROUPS:

18-29 30-44 45-60 >60

Note: Percentages may not total 100% due to rounding and/or because respondents could select more than one answer.



PURCHASE BEHAVIOR



PURCHASE BEHAVIOR: KEY TAKEAWAYS

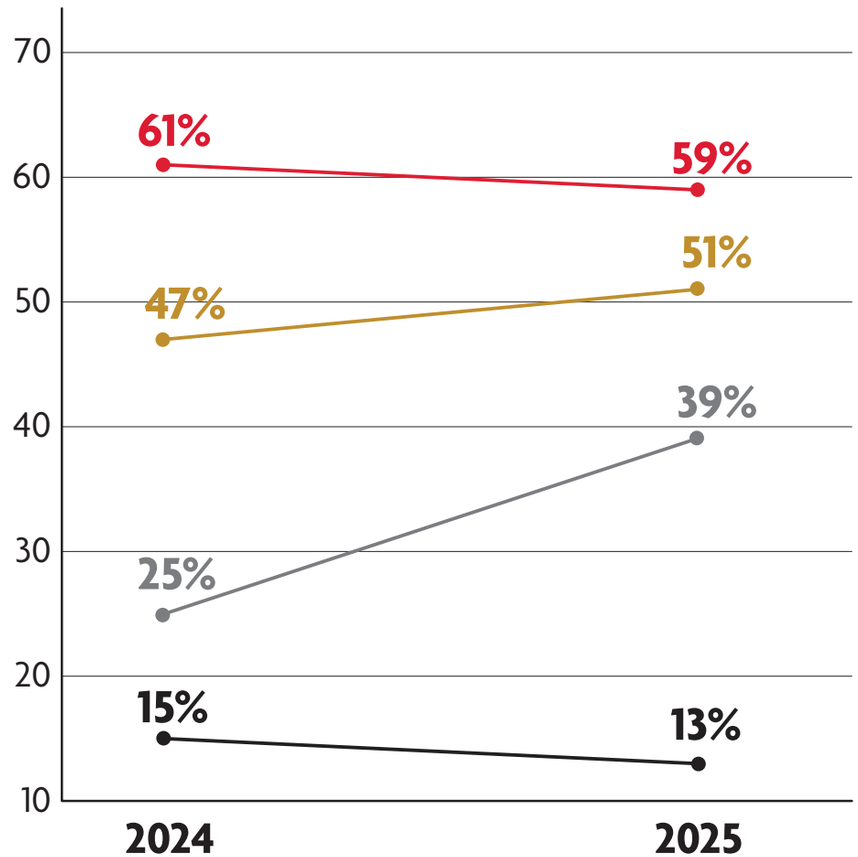
- Experience is the leading driver of physical shopping.
- Price comparison is the most commonly used research method among online shoppers.
- Cleaning products, toys, and vitamins/ supplements exhibited the most annual growth.
- Holiday purchasing patterns signal key omnichannel and consumer loyalty opportunities.



Experience is the leading driver of physical shopping.

"Which of the following statements describes your in-store shopping preferences?"

- I shop in-store because I enjoy the experience (trying on products, comparing products in person, etc.).
- I shop in-store only when I need something immediately.
- I shop in-store because I don't want to wait for online orders in the mail.
- I shop in-store to avoid package theft.



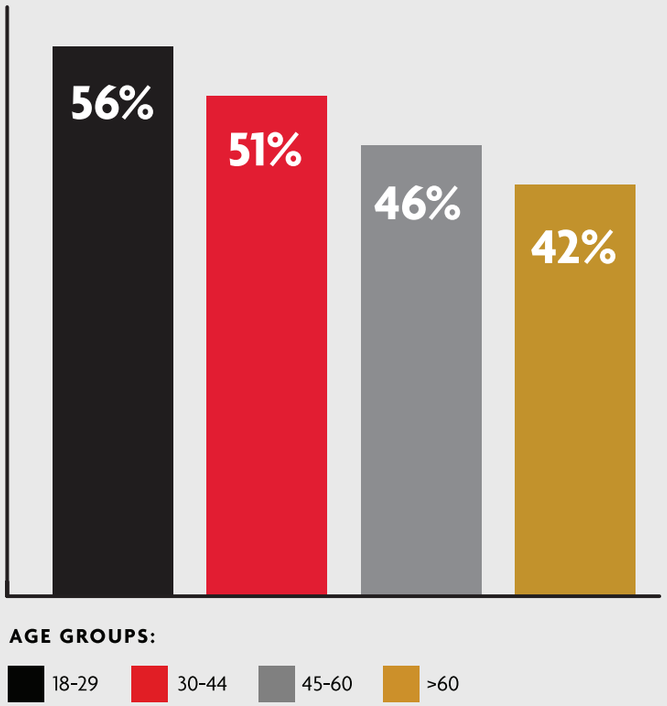
Note: Percentages may not total 100% due to rounding and/or because respondents could select more than one answer.

Price comparison is the most commonly used research method among online shoppers.

"Which of the following do you typically do before purchasing a product online?"



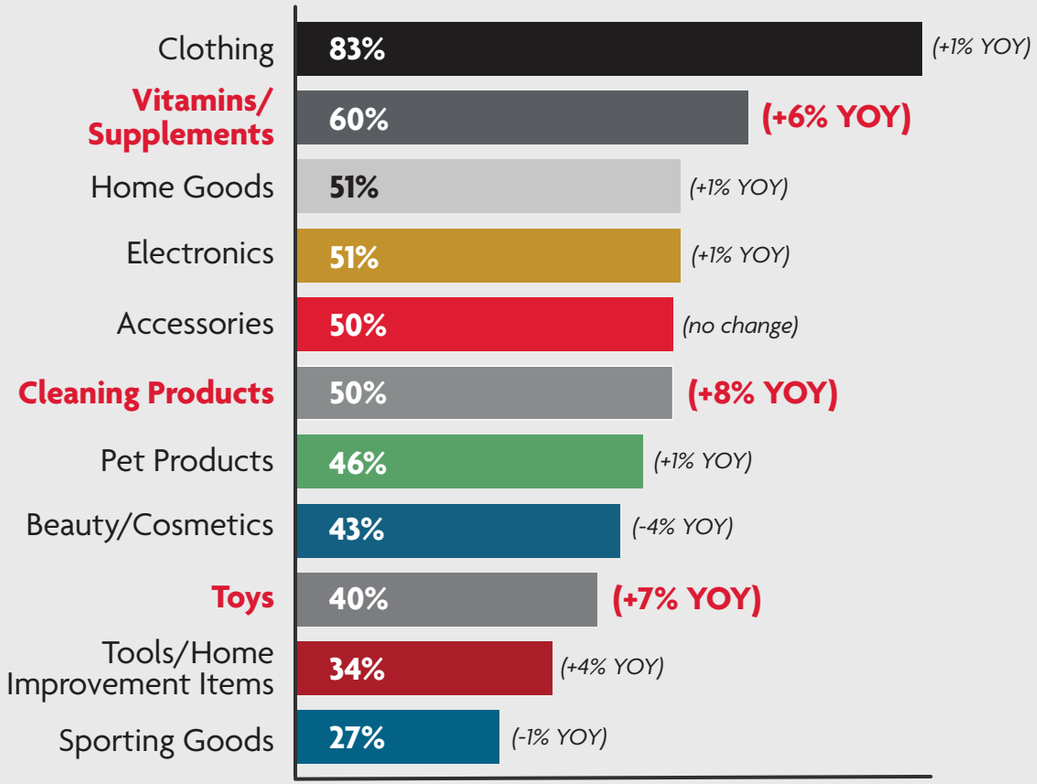
Consumers who report inflation is driving them to do more comparison shopping:



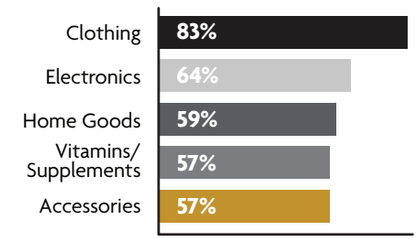
Note: Percentages may not total 100% due to rounding and/or because respondents could select more than one answer.

Cleaning products, toys, and vitamins/ supplements exhibited the most annual growth.

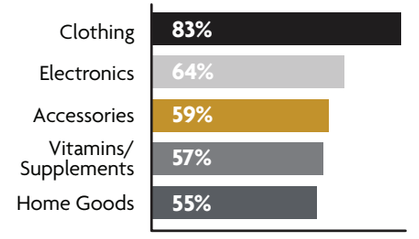
"Which of the following have you purchased online in the past year?"



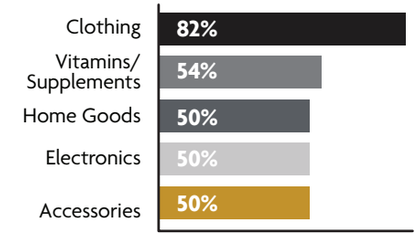
2022 TOP 5



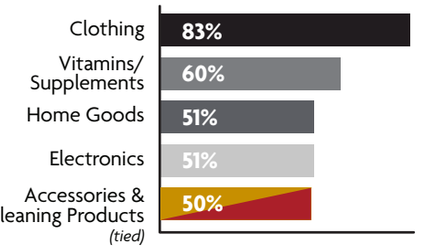
2023 TOP 5



2024 TOP 5



2025 TOP 5



Note: Percentages may not total 100% due to rounding and/or because respondents could select more than one answer.

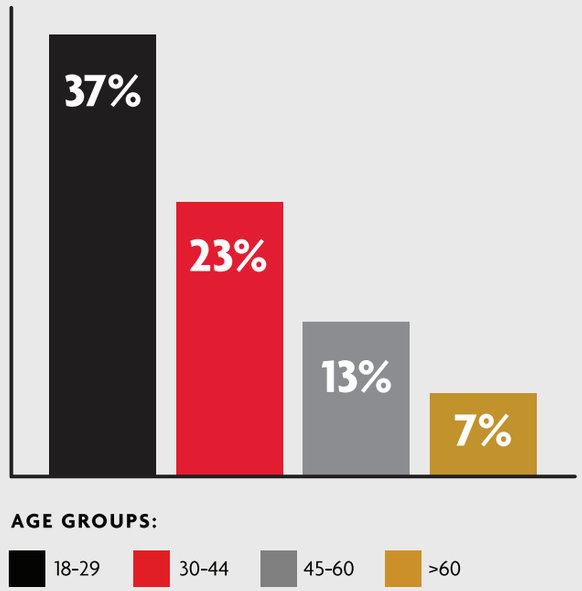
Holiday purchasing patterns signal key omnichannel and consumer loyalty opportunities.

62%

of shoppers use retailer loyalty/ rewards points more during the holiday season than the rest of the year.

(+12% YOY)

Younger shoppers use BNPL methods more during the holiday season than the rest of the year.



I use Buy Online Pickup In Store (BOPIS) more during the holiday season than the rest of the year.

45% *(+1% YOY)*

I use Buy Online Return in Store (BORIS) more during the holiday season than the rest of the year.

39% *(-1% YOY)*

Note: Percentages may not total 100% due to rounding and/or because respondents could select more than one answer.

OMNICHANNEL

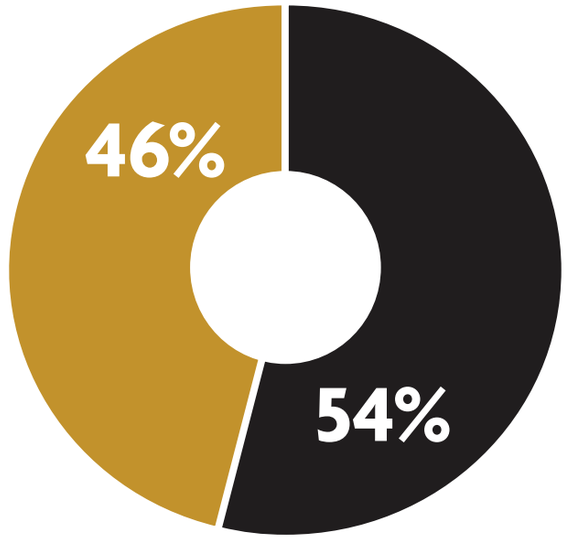


OMNICHANNEL: KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Recently emerged consumer preference for in-store returns holds steady.
- Shoppers seek alternative delivery options to prevent package theft.
- Shipping fees and convenience drive Buy Online Pickup In Store (BOPIS) activity.
- Consumers appear slightly less reliant on mobile devices to aid in-store shopping.



Recently emerged consumer preference for in-store returns holds steady.

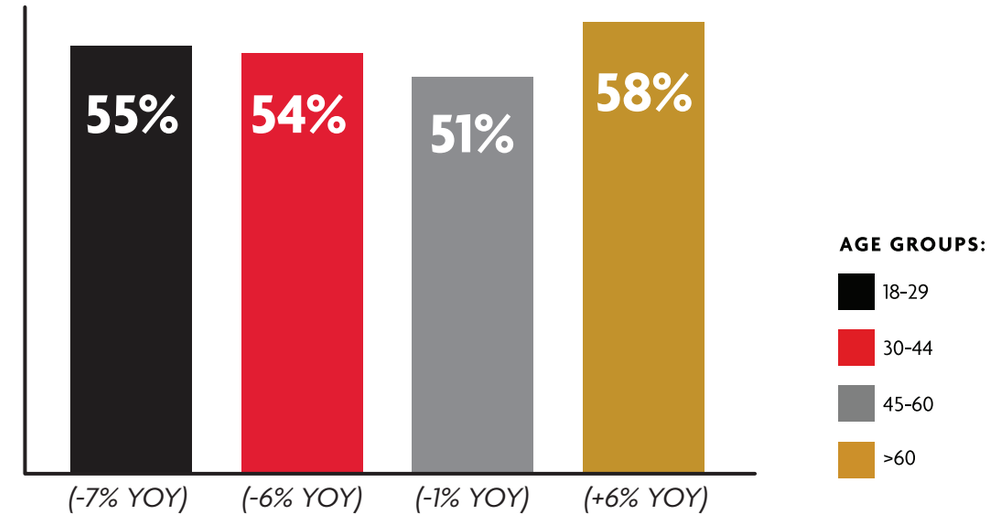


Prefer to return online purchases in-store. *(-1% YOY)*

Prefer to return online purchases via mail/drop box. *(+1% YOY)*

Evolving return preferences across age groups underscore the need for flexible omnichannel offerings.

Preference for in-store returns by age group:



Note: Percentages may not total 100% due to rounding and/or because respondents could select more than one answer.